Not Dragon at the Gate but Research Partner
不是守门的恶龙，而是研究伙伴

The Reference Archivist as Mediator
参考咨询档案员作为中介者

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In a keynote address given to the Spring 2000 Midwest Archives Conference meeting (hereafter Sawyer Seminar), Francis Blouin set out the founding principles for this seminar as a dialogue between historians and other scholars, and the archivists who maintain documentary collections for research use. As became clear from the seminar conversations that ensued, the concept of "archive" has a broader range of definitions than those of us who are practitioners in the field might have imagined. What also became clear was that the archivist's role in the maintenance of this documentation was not at all clear.

在为2000年春季美国中西部档案会议所作的主旨演讲中（下文称"索耶研讨会"），弗朗西斯·布卢因阐明了这次研讨会的基本宗旨：让历史学家及其他学者，与管理供研究使用的文献馆藏的档案员展开对话。随后的讨论表明，"档案"这一概念的定义范围，比我们这些档案工作者原先所设想的更为宽广。与此同时，也明显可以看出，人们对于档案员在保存这些文献过程中所扮演的角色，认识十分模糊。

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Many of the participants, citing the derivation of the term *archives* "from the Latin *archivuum*, 'residence of the magistrate,'" appeared to conflate past and present accessibility of archival documentation. For many, the concept of archives was a purely theoretical one: "In cultural theory, 'the archive' is endowed with a capital "A," is figurative, and leads elsewhere. It may represent neither material site nor a set of documents. Rather it may serve as a strong metaphor for any corpus of selective forgettings and collections," wrote one participant. The singular lack of interest in the realities of current archival practice and theory was demonstrated by the lack of attendance by these scholars at later seminar sessions on archival topics.

许多与会者援引archives一词"源自拉丁语archivuum，即'行政长官的住所'"的说法，似乎将档案文献过去的可获取性与今天的可获取性混为一谈。对许多人而言，档案是一个纯粹理论性的概念。一位与会者写道：“在文化理论中，'档案'被赋予了一个大写的'A'，具有比喻性质，并将人引向别处。它可能既不代表实体场所，也不代表一组文献。相反，它可能成为一个强有力的隐喻，指称任何由选择性遗忘与收集所构成的集合。”这些学者没有出席后来讨论档案议题的研讨会场次，这表明他们对当代档案实践和理论的实际状况，几乎毫无兴趣。

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Most disturbing, however, were statements such as “Foucault [in his *Archaeology of Knowledge]* provocatively warned [that] the archive is neither the sum of all texts that a culture preserves nor those institutions that allow for that record and preservation.”[1] It is a useful warning to current archivists that such a perception still exists. We are only too aware that, through selection and other factors affecting the availability of texts for collection, we house only a fraction of history's documents. Archivists also assume, perhaps naively, that our researchers have always subjected these texts to scrutiny and skepticism as to their meanings and origins.

然而，最令人不安的是这样的说法：“福柯 [在《知识考古学》中] 以挑衅性的方式警告说，档案既不是一种文化所保存的全部文本的总和，也不是使这种记录和保存成为可能的那些机构。”[1]对今天的档案员而言，得知这种认识依然存在，是一个有益的提醒。我们非常清楚，由于选择，以及影响文本能否被收集的其他因素，我们保存的只是历史文献中的一小部分。档案员也认为——这种想法或许过于天真——研究者始终会审视这些文本，并对其含义和来源保持怀疑。

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At the same time, Blouin and others challenged archivists with the “need to become more self-aware of our role as mediators . . . between records creators and records repositories, between archives and users, between conceptions of the past and extant documentation.”[2]

与此同时，布卢因等人向档案员提出了挑战，要求我们“更加自觉地认识自己作为中介者的角色……介于文件形成者与文件保存机构之间，介于档案与使用者之间，介于对过去的观念与现存文献之间”。[2]

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While I absolutely believe that the archivist has agency in the research process, I would characterize it instead as a consultancy, and myself as a partner in re-search.[3] I will explain this more fully later in this essay.

虽然我完全相信档案员在研究过程中具有能动性，但我更愿意把这种作用界定为咨询，把自己看作研究的伙伴。[3]我将在本文后面更充分地解释这一点。

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First, however, I have found that the fluidity of the concept of archives, among those who use archival documents but do not claim archivist as a profession, is quite disconcerting. I believe a brief digression about the purpose of keeping archives is in order. I hope to show that much of what characterizes what I consider to be an archives also highlights the contributions that I, as a reference archivist, bring to the research partnership: my knowledge of the breadth of the collections, the nature of recordkeeping, and the contextual information that gives documents their “greater than the sum of their parts” meaning.

不过，首先我发现，那些使用档案文献、却并不以档案员为职业的人，对于档案概念的理解如此流动不定，实在令人不安。我认为，有必要稍稍离题，简要讨论保存档案的目的。我希望说明，在我看来构成档案的许多特征，也凸显了我作为参考咨询档案员为研究伙伴关系所作的贡献：我了解馆藏的广度、文件管理的性质，以及赋予文献“整体大于各部分之和”意义的背景信息。

The Repeatable Experiment
可重复的实验

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Elizabeth Yakel, in her article “Thinking Inside and Outside the Boxes: Archival Reference Services at the Close of the Twentieth Century,” has put it most succinctly: “The enduring value of archives is partly that certain records can be continuing sources of knowledge.”[4] While this may no longer be the scholar's concept of archives, it is the foundation of all that the archivist works toward: the collection and description of documents to be universally available for study by anyone. The corollary most applicable to the reference archivist is that these documents should not be changed by their use but remain available for future generations to study, to use to gain new insights, and to make further comparisons.

伊丽莎白·雅克尔在《在盒子内外思考：二十世纪末的档案参考咨询服务》一文中，以最简洁的方式指出：“档案的持久价值，部分在于某些文件能够不断成为知识的来源。”[4]虽然这或许已不再是学者对档案的理解，但它仍是档案员所有工作的根基：收集并描述文献，使任何人都能普遍获取并加以研究。对于参考咨询档案员而言，最切身的推论是，这些文献不应因使用而发生变化，而应继续保存下来，供后代研究、从中获得新的见解，并进一步作出比较。

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While some very real criticisms can be leveled at the varied processes of collecting over time, there are two distinct concepts here: whether every documentary collection is necessarily incomplete, and whether anything can be an archive.

尽管可以对不同时期的各种收集过程提出一些确实成立的批评，但这里涉及两个不同的概念：是否每个文献集合都必然不完整，以及是否任何事物都可以称为档案。

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Blouin notes that “instead of directing the process of uncovering the past through available fragments, the archive is subordinated as one contested element in a variety of tangible and nontangible elements that help construct a sense, an image, a theory, or a representation of a particular past.”[5] So, are we all archivists of our own archives? That does cast a different light on the guidelines for archival use: respect original order, remove nothing from the repository, maintain an emphasis on preservation and provenance. An archival repository attempts to guarantee that all researchers' experience with a collection of documents will begin with the same available set—regardless of which collections they select or what conclusions they may draw from each collection. Other archives are, in our terms, ephemeral or inconsistent, or harder to access, or subject to interpretation by a donor still in control of the collection. All facts may be facts, all social memory useful, and all understandings valid. But, if I can't follow a set of citations and examine what was used to come to the conclusions, then there will always be just one interpretation of that fact or understanding. Archivists strive to make just the opposite possible.

布卢因指出：“档案不再通过现有碎片来引导揭示过去的过程，而是被置于从属地位，成为各种有形和无形要素中一个有争议的要素；这些要素有助于建构关于某段特定过去的感受、形象、理论或表征。”[5]那么，我们是否都是各自档案的档案员？这种说法确实使档案利用的准则呈现出不同的面貌：尊重原有顺序，不从保存机构拿走任何材料，并重视保存与来源。档案保存机构力图保证，无论研究者选择哪些馆藏，或从各个馆藏得出什么结论，每个人面对一组文献时，最初都能接触到同一套可用材料。用我们的术语来说，其他“档案”可能是短暂的、不稳定的、更难获取的，或仍受控制馆藏的捐赠者解释所支配。所有事实都可能是事实，所有社会记忆都可能有用，所有理解都可能有效。但是，如果我不能沿着一组引注找到并查看用于得出结论的材料，那么，对那个事实或那种理解就始终只能有一种解释。档案员努力促成的，恰恰是相反的可能性。

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Indeed, there is an implied responsibility of the archivist to guarantee, or at least be able to explain or appraise, the evidential value of documents retained by an archives. There is no question that many experiences remain undocumented. For the past several decades it has been a major aim of archivists, many educated at the same time as the new social historian, to seek out this more ephemeral documentation and enrich their collections with a broader view of society. But, once the documents were located (or even created, in the case of the growing body of oral history collections), they became part of the archives. As such, their keepers were charged with the dual responsibilities of making them widely known and available—and guaranteeing that they remained the way they were found, unaltered and identical for each researcher.

实际上，档案员负有一种隐含的责任：保证档案馆所保留文献的证据价值，或至少能够解释、评估这种价值。毫无疑问，许多经历没有被记录下来。在过去几十年间，档案员的一项主要目标，就是寻找这种更易消逝的文献，以更广阔的社会视野充实馆藏；其中许多档案员与新社会史学家是在同一时期接受教育的。不过，文献一经找到——甚至在数量日增的口述历史收藏中被创造出来——便成为档案的一部分。因此，它们的保管者承担着双重责任：使这些材料广为人知并可供利用，同时保证它们保持发现时的样貌，未经改动，对每一位研究者都完全相同。

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A postmodernist approach might decree that all meanings derived from our collections are valid and useful. But the archivist still feels a responsibility to impart the original constructs—old meanings of words or contextual realities that obtained when the documents were created—for the interested researcher.

后现代主义的方法或许会宣称，从馆藏中得出的所有意义都是有效而有用的。但档案员仍然觉得有责任向感兴趣的研究者传达原初的意义构成，包括词语过去的含义，以及文献形成时存在的背景现实。

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This brings us back to the concept of mediation, and the role of the reference archivist. I should clarify, first, that there are many ways in which archivists mediate between documentation and researcher. Deciding how to focus a collection, what to collect, which portions of a collection to preserve, and arranging and describing these materials for public use all inherently shape the user's perceptions of their research topic. In this essay, however, I will focus on the mediated experience of the reference interaction. Whether this happens face to face or in a digital environment, attitudes, intentions, and awareness can entirely change what the researcher discovers and whether he or she is successful in locating all the archival sources that will be useful for the project undertaken.

这使我们重新回到中介这一概念，以及参考咨询档案员的角色。我首先应当说明，档案员在文献与研究者之间发挥中介作用的方式有很多。决定馆藏的重点、收集什么、保存馆藏的哪些部分，以及为公众利用而整理和描述材料，这些活动本身都会塑造使用者对研究主题的认识。不过，在本文中，我将重点讨论参考咨询互动中的中介经验。无论这种互动发生在面对面的场合，还是数字环境中，态度、意图和意识，都可能彻底改变研究者的发现，以及他或她能否成功找到对所从事项目有用的全部档案来源。

Dragon at the Gate?

守门的恶龙？

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I am very aware that archivists and researchers often play adversarial roles. Some of this comes from misconceptions about who makes access decisions and how, and a distaste for what seem like too many, or too capricious, sets of rules. Some of it also comes from a sense of ownership, not shared with the researcher, which I have observed in too many of my colleagues. When I was at the MIT Archives, the archivist told us of her predecessor, who had carefully collected the files from an institute-wide committee on academic values. But, when the faculty member who deposited those records came back to refer to them several months later, he was told, “Oh no. You can't see those now. They're in the *archives.”* Case closed. Needless to say, much of our challenge in administering the archives consisted of undoing this impression and encouraging use.

我非常清楚，档案员与研究者经常处于对立的位置。这种对立有一部分源于误解：谁作出开放利用的决定，又如何作出决定；也有一部分源于对似乎过多或过于随意的规则的反感。此外，还有一部分源于一种不愿与研究者分享的占有意识，而我在太多同事身上都观察到过这种意识。我在麻省理工学院档案馆工作时，档案员向我们讲述了她的前任的故事：那位前任曾认真收集一个全校学术价值委员会的文件。但是，几个月后，当移交这些文件的教师回来查阅时，他却被告知：“哦，不行。你现在不能看了。它们已经进档案馆了。”事情到此为止。不必多说，我们管理档案馆的许多挑战，就在于消除这种印象，并鼓励人们使用档案。

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One of the most important ways in which the reference archivist can mediate the experience of a researcher in the archives is to continue what one of my colleagues calls “the conversation.”[6] This is not a particularly startling concept, but it ensures that the mutually educational process (“what are you finding?”/ “what does this say?”) continues unimpeded.

参考咨询档案员能够调节研究者档案利用经验的最重要方式之一，就是持续开展我一位同事所称的“对话”。[6]这并不是什么特别惊人的概念，但它能确保双方相互学习的过程——“你发现了什么？”/ “这里说的是什么？”——不受阻碍地继续下去。

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The first step in mediation is to ensure that what can sometimes be an antagonistic relationship instead begins to build a research team. If the communication is bad, it often ensures that the rest of the research enterprise never even happens. Researchers come in to pick up a quick answer and then discover that it will be a long search process, and they must wait while items are retrieved, one at a time, and they can't copy things themselves, and half the collections are in offsite storage. Empowerment is actually a very helpful way to look at reference. Not wanting to look incompetent is as important a research motivator as creating research products such as getting an A on a paper or meeting a report deadline. We see it on researchers' faces as they walk in the door, we hear it in their defensive comments over the phone and e-mail.

中介工作的第一步，是确保有时可能带有敌意的关系开始转化为研究团队。沟通不畅，往往意味着其余研究活动根本不会发生。研究者进来，希望迅速得到答案，随后却发现查找过程很漫长：他们必须等待材料逐件调取，不能自行复印，而一半馆藏又存放在馆外。事实上，以赋能的角度理解参考咨询很有帮助。不希望显得无能，是一种研究动机，其重要性不亚于产出研究成果，例如论文拿到A，或赶上报告的截止日期。研究者走进门时，我们从他们脸上看得到这一点；通过电话或电子邮件交流时，我们也从他们带有防御性的言语中听得到。

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Archival researchers often begin their interactions with “I'm new here,” or “I don't know anything,” or “This is going to sound stupid.”[7] Clearly the first task of the archivist is not going to be defining provenance or copyright or scope and content notes. Before any other interaction can take place the archivist must make the researcher feel welcome and attended to, and that, yes, it is very possible to navigate this place and get some good and useful information for his or her project. Oh, and could you lock up all your belongings and put away your pen and we may ask you to wear gloves and come back later for your copies. It is a difficult balancing act for the reference archivist to simultaneously communicate the desirability of the researcher's presence and also the necessity of obeying rules regarding access and handling to ensure the preservation of what the researcher wants to use.

档案研究者往往这样开始交谈：“我是新来的”“我什么都不懂”，或者“这话听起来会很蠢”。[7]显然，档案员的首要任务不是解释来源原则、版权或范围与内容说明。在其他互动发生之前，档案员必须让研究者感到受欢迎、受到关注，并相信：没错，完全有可能熟悉这里的使用方法，为自己的项目获得优质、有用的信息。哦，不过，能否请你把所有随身物品锁起来，收好钢笔？我们也许还会请你戴上手套，并晚些时候回来取复印件。参考咨询档案员必须维持一种艰难的平衡：一方面传达我们欢迎研究者到来，另一方面说明，为了保护研究者想用的材料，必须遵守开放利用和材料操作的规则。

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This is where archivists play an educational role. I like to stress the treasure hunt aspect of archival research with the media and with the public: it can be a tough job, but there really is treasure at the end of the hunt. And we as reference archivists are here to show you where and how to dig so that the process doesn't seem so mystifying and impossible.

这正是档案员发挥教育作用的地方。我喜欢向媒体和公众强调档案研究的寻宝性质：过程可能艰难，但终点确实有宝藏。我们这些参考咨询档案员就在这里，向你说明到哪里挖掘、怎样挖掘，让这个过程显得不那么神秘莫测、难以完成。

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This brings us back to empowerment. Archivists' pride, too, is on the line. Some of my proudest moments have been when an unhappy or disgruntled researcher feels heard and ends up having a productive time in my reading room. By assisting researchers and managing a good outcome, rather than by using our authority to point out only what they are doing incorrectly, archivists win as do the researchers. Saving face sounds like a selfish motivation, but it's often the reality of these interactions. The trick is to make it work for the partnership, not against it.

这又把我们带回赋能的问题。档案员的自尊同样在其中。我最自豪的一些时刻，是让不满或愤愤不平的研究者感到自己的诉求被听见，并最终在我的阅览室取得成果。通过帮助研究者、促成良好结果，而不是利用权威一味指出他们做错了什么，档案员与研究者便能共同受益。保全面子听起来像是一种自私的动机，却往往是这些互动中的实际情况。关键在于让它有助于伙伴关系，而不是损害这种关系。

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When I was the reference archivist at MIT, I conducted a reference interview with a visiting historian of science. He arrived asking to see what sources we had in the history of nuclear medicine. Immediately my mind began racing to the answer I thought he wanted—and coming up blank because MIT doesn't have a medical school. I felt ignorant about the nature of the topic—not an uncommon occurrence in that job—but I took a breath and said, “You know, I really don't know anything about nuclear medicine. Can you tell me a bit about it and we can see where that might lead us?” It turned out he was exploring the medical applications of research in physics, and in that field we had an abundance of collections. The researcher spent several days using personal and institute records in the archives. Braving my own sense of embarrassment to learn from him allowed me to be of much greater use in providing information about the history and organizational structure of my institution.

我在麻省理工学院担任参考咨询档案员时，曾与一位来访的科学史学家进行参考咨询访谈。他一来就询问我们有哪些核医学史资料。我的脑海立即飞快搜寻我以为他想要的答案，却一无所获，因为麻省理工学院没有医学院。我觉得自己不了解这个主题——这在那份工作中并不罕见——但我深吸一口气，说：“你知道，我对核医学真的一无所知。你能给我讲一点吗？我们可以看看这会把我们引向哪里。”原来，他研究的是物理学研究在医学上的应用，而我们恰好有大量相关馆藏。他随后花了几天时间，利用档案馆中的私人文件和学院文件。我克服了自己的尴尬，向他学习，从而能更有效地提供本校历史与组织结构的信息。

Reference Archivist Roles
参考咨询档案员的角色

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On a typical day we play more roles than Alec Guinness in the film *Kind Hearts and Coronets*. Every day we play the roles of tour guide, teacher, consultant, salesperson, matchmaker—and certainly mediator. Each role uses different aspects of our knowledge as reference specialists and archivists to connect the wide variety of researchers interested in using our collections, the various finding aids and tools archivists construct to make the materials accessible—and the actual documents themselves.

平常的一天里，我们扮演的角色，比亚历克·吉尼斯在电影《仁心与冠冕》中扮演的还多。我们每天都是导游、教师、顾问、推销员、媒人，当然也是中介者。每种角色都运用我们作为参考咨询专家和档案员所掌握知识的不同方面，把希望使用馆藏的各类研究者、档案员为便于获取材料而制作的各类检索工具，以及文献本身连接起来。

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The first step is outreach: this can be as complicated as an interactive online exhibit featuring primary source material, or as simple as making sure the archives is represented in the brochure rack at the library. The general principle is the same: archivists try never to assume that their publics understand the value of archival materials, how these materials can be useful in their professional or personal lives, or how to discover what we have and how to use it. In my position as reference archivist at an academic archives, I placed a high priority on reaching out to students and faculty, to whom I offered introductions that could be titled “What's an Archives and What'll It Get You?”[8]1 also worked with administrators whose noncurrent records are held in the library. Much of this work could be summed up as the antithesis of the example I gave above: “Oh yes. Please use those records now that they're in the archives. Case opened!” We don't wait for researchers to find us. At every opportunity, we insert ourselves into the research process with reminders of the richness of our holdings and research assistance we provide.

第一步是对外推广：它可以复杂到制作以一手资料为特色的互动式网络展览，也可以简单到确保图书馆的宣传册架上有档案馆的介绍。基本原则相同：档案员尽量不预设公众已理解档案材料的价值、这些材料如何有助于他们的职业或个人生活，以及怎样发现和利用我们的馆藏。我在大学档案馆担任参考咨询档案员时，非常重视联系学生和教师，为他们作可以题为“档案馆是什么，能给你带来什么？”的介绍。[8]我也与那些非现行文件保存在图书馆中的行政人员合作。许多工作可以用与前述例子相反的一句话概括：“哦，当然。既然这些文件已经进了档案馆，请来使用它们。事情由此开启！”我们不等研究者找上门。只要有机会，我们便参与研究过程，提醒他们馆藏的丰富性，以及我们能够提供的研究帮助。

Much of the educational work of the reference archivist does come in the form of deliberate instruction, such as orientation sessions, and online tutorials such as Yale University's.[9] Just as often, though, this education is the less formal one-on-one orientation, in-house or via email, in using and interpreting primary sources. This skill is surprisingly rarely taught in any academic curriculum, so the researcher often finds him- or herself with a box of raw material and no experience in placing it within a context or evaluating its contemporary meaning. The reference archivist comes to recognize a variety of signals from a crooked finger, a tentative “excuse me?” or “hey you,” all of which indicate this confusion. Our job is to help them puzzle through the item, ask the larger questions, assist in reading the ancient handwriting, explain an outdated form, help place the correspondent within the organization's hierarchy at the time of the document's creation, or suggest related reading. Often, for example, researchers don't make the connection between a faculty member as private researcher and the records they may have created in an administrative role. Helping researchers to make these connections and to think in a different way is part of the ongoing education that takes place in archival reading rooms every day. More importantly, we convey to researchers the skills to make these connections on their own the next time they encounter a puzzling bit of what Blouin calls the “available fragments of history.”

参考咨询档案员的许多教育工作确实采取有计划的教学形式，例如入门指导活动，以及耶鲁大学那样的网络教程。[9]不过，同样常见的是在馆内或通过电子邮件，一对一地非正式指导研究者使用和解释一手资料。令人惊讶的是，学术课程很少教授这项技能，因此研究者往往面对一盒原始材料，却没有经验把它放进背景中，或评估它在形成时代的含义。参考咨询档案员会逐渐识别各种信号：招手的手指、试探性的“打扰一下？”或“喂”，都说明研究者感到困惑。我们的工作是帮助他们逐步理解材料、提出更宏观的问题、辨读古老的笔迹、解释过时的表格、确定写信人在文献形成时所处的组织层级，或推荐相关阅读。例如，研究者常常无法把作为私人研究者的教师，与其担任行政职务时可能形成的文件联系起来。帮助研究者建立这些联系、换一种方式思考，是档案阅览室每天持续发生的教育活动的一部分。更重要的是，我们把这种能力传授给研究者，使他们下次遇到布卢因所说的令人费解的“现有历史碎片”时，能够独立建立联系。

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Yakel also stresses the translator role of the archivist and adds that translators must understand both languages or cultures to function well.[10] Researchers approach us with questions phrased in the language of their own discipline. We rephrase the question, adding information about the nature of our records, as well as instruction in how to understand the language of our search engine, the cataloging and filing rules of the Online Computer Library Center (OCLC) database, Library of Congress (LC) descriptions, and the structure of our individual online catalogs. Indeed, LC subject headings and “neutral” descriptive language are often arcane, value laden, and hopelessly behind the times. New “natural language” keyword searches are better, as they aren't dependent on the LC authority over various iterations—but the natural language is that of the cataloguer, nonetheless. Regardless, these standardized descriptive conventions are how our collections are to be understood. It is the reference archivist's job to translate the language and impart the skills needed to use the research tools.

雅克尔还强调档案员的翻译者角色，并指出翻译者必须理解两种语言或文化，才能有效工作。[10]研究者用自己学科的语言来提问。我们会重新表述问题，加入关于文件性质的信息，并指导他们理解检索系统的语言、联机计算机图书馆中心（OCLC）数据库的编目与排列规则、美国国会图书馆（LC）的描述方式，以及各馆联机目录的结构。实际上，LC主题词和所谓“中立”的描述语言，往往晦涩难懂、带有价值判断，并且严重落后于时代。新的“自然语言”关键词检索更好，因为它们不依赖LC对不同表达形式所作的规范控制；但这种自然语言毕竟仍是编目员的语言。无论如何，人们必须通过这些标准化的描述惯例来理解馆藏。参考咨询档案员的工作，就是翻译这些语言，并传授使用研究工具所需的技能。

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Clearly, another significant role of the reference archivist is in training researchers to think like archivists.[11] This is not to say that we train them to be archivists. It means that the concept of understanding a bureaucracy in order to request the records from the appropriate office, or to think about how an individual organized their files in order to know which box to request, is a foreign one to our users. This is a perfect example of the archivist as translator; archives have a language all their own that shows no immediate signs of changing. “Scope and content note,” “provenance,” “EAD”—even “finding aid”—usually draws a blank (“Finding what?” I'm often asked). We not only translate the lingo of the archivist, we also convey the value of the concepts communicated by these terms: how would you express the merits of a scope and content note? And, more importantly, how would you, in just a sentence or two, sell the researcher on not skipping past this useful information to head straight for the tantalizing box list (which they do every day)?

显然，参考咨询档案员的另一项重要角色，是训练研究者像档案员那样思考。[11]这并不是把他们训练成档案员，而是说：为了向适当部门申请文件而先了解官僚机构，或为了确定应调哪一盒材料而先思考某个人如何组织文件，这些思路对使用者而言很陌生。这正是档案员作为翻译者的典型例子；档案有自己独特的语言，而且暂时看不出改变的迹象。“范围与内容说明”“来源”“EAD”，甚至“检索工具”，通常都会让人一头雾水（我经常被问：“检索什么？”）。我们不仅要翻译档案员的行话，还要传达这些术语所表达概念的价值：怎样说明范围与内容说明的好处？更重要的是，怎样只用一两句话，就能说服研究者不要跳过这些有用信息，直接奔向诱人的盒目录——而他们每天都这样做？

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The most traditional archival finding aid, for example, is based on a strictly hierarchical structure. Organizations exist in hierarchies, and the records of their officers are arranged that way. Even the finding aids themselves run—at least until the Encoded Archival Description (EAD) format bled the lines between physical and intellectual order—on an implacable hierarchy of series, box, folder. The series are described in the front matter, then lists of their contents follow. Series are in order but broken across boxes. Boxes are listed at the beginning but not with each folder. Once the concept is explained, it is easy to follow, but until then even the most sophisticated researcher, unfamiliar with archives, will approach us and ask us to explain how this “book” (finding aid) works. Online finding aids follow the same structure, and we are beginning to think of general instructions to orient researchers to the most effective use of these new widely available tools. Wading through this structure and translating as I go often does remind me of being a tour guide. If the past is a foreign country, then educating researchers about using archives can feel like conducting a Berlitz course.

例如，最传统的档案检索工具，以严格的层级结构为基础。组织具有层级，其人员形成的文件也按这一层级排列。即使检索工具本身，也遵循文件系列、盒、文件夹的严格层级——至少在编码档案描述（EAD）格式模糊实体顺序与知识顺序的界线之前如此。前面的说明部分先描述各系列，随后列出其内容。系列依次排列，却跨越不同的盒。盒号列在开头，而不是每个文件夹之前。概念解释清楚后，很容易理解；在此之前，即使最老练的研究者，如果不熟悉档案，也会来请我们解释这本“书”（检索工具）怎样使用。网络检索工具也采用同样结构，而我们正开始考虑提供一般性指导，让研究者最有效地使用这些新近广泛开放的工具。带人穿过这种结构，并一路解释，往往让我想起导游的工作。如果过去是一个异国，那么教研究者使用档案，就像开设一门贝立兹语言课程。

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In fact, in archival reference workshops I begin with a brainstorming session where we write down “What Every Researcher Should Know.” This results in a list of what we wish researchers entering our reading rooms, or accessing us by electronic means, to understand about how archives work. In addition to the usual procedural rules, there are the assumptions that archivists make: about the hierarchical structure, about respecting original order, about the fact that most collections are organized as their creator or author intended, not rearranged for some future research use. These concepts, too, must be translated or explained—and we don't even all agree on them: witness ongoing archival discussions of the continued value of provenance!

事实上，在档案参考咨询工作坊中，我会先安排头脑风暴，写下“每个研究者都应该知道的事情”。由此形成一份清单，列出我们希望走进阅览室或通过电子方式联系的研究者，对于档案运作应当理解的内容。除了通常的程序规则，还包括档案员的一些预设：层级结构、尊重原有顺序，以及大多数馆藏按照形成者或作者的意图组织，而不是为未来某种研究用途重新排列。这些概念也需要翻译或解释，而且我们自己也并非完全一致：档案界关于来源原则是否仍有价值的持续讨论，便是明证！

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Access restrictions also require the mediation and intervention of the archivist—to explain and to handle the process of gaining access. Consider, for example, many researchers' experiences in the Soviet Union, before and after the fall of the communist state, where bribes might be required to facilitate access, files might be withheld capriciously, and records might be sold for money to heat buildings. Blouin noted, “it is the extreme case of Soviet Russia that exposes a process that is part and parcel of all archival institutions that struggle with the challenges of bulk, historical preconceptions, and specific institutional responsibilities.”[12] Most such restrictions are the result of government regulations or the wishes of individual donors on giving their private property to an archival repository. They are the conditions of the gift, not the wish of the repository.

开放利用限制同样需要档案员的中介与介入，以解释并处理取得使用权限的过程。例如，许多研究者在苏联，无论共产主义国家解体前后，都经历过这样的情况：为了顺利获取材料可能需要行贿，文件可能被任意扣留，甚至可能被出售，以换取建筑物取暖的费用。布卢因指出：“苏俄这一极端案例揭示了一种过程；凡是努力应对材料数量、历史成见以及特定机构责任等挑战的档案机构，都不可避免地涉及这一过程。”[12]多数这类限制源于政府规定，或个人捐赠者将私有财产移交档案保存机构时提出的要求。它们是捐赠的条件，而不是保存机构的愿望。

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The Society of American Archivists' Code of Ethics[13] specifies that archivists weigh equally their organizational responsibilities, or the needs of the donor, with the needs of researchers for ready access. It falls to the reference archivist to standardize the procedure of requesting access, negotiate the request in as timely a way as possible, and communicate to the researcher that this is neither a capricious nor unusual practice.

美国档案工作者协会的《伦理准则》[13]规定，档案员应同等权衡其组织责任或捐赠者的需求，以及研究者便捷获取材料的需求。参考咨询档案员负责规范申请使用的程序，尽可能及时地协商处理申请，并向研究者说明，这既非随意之举，也非罕见做法。

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An equally intermediary role delineated by Yakel is that of the knowledge broker. The archivist often crosses boundaries in ways that other individuals in organizations or academia don't tend to: they are the true inter- disciplinarians, for they not only know many areas of study, as do librarians, but they are also familiar with knowledge needs, and political realities, throughout the parent organization. Yakel argues that archivists must take their place “as an equal and active participant with users in the knowledge creation process.”[14] This echoes my belief in the consultant nature of the reference archivist's work.

雅克尔提出的另一种同样具有中介性质的角色，是知识经纪人。档案员经常以组织或学术界其他个人不常采用的方式跨越边界：他们是真正的跨学科工作者，因为他们不仅像图书馆员一样了解许多研究领域，还熟悉所属机构各处的知识需求与政治现实。雅克尔认为，档案员必须“以平等而积极的参与者身份，与使用者共同参与知识创造过程”。[14]这呼应了我对于参考咨询档案员工作具有顾问性质的看法。

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I originally developed my archival reference workshop with a training specialist. She informed me immediately that the job of reference in archives, as she was coming to understand it, was that of a consultant. This was news to me. But as I considered it, I realized that consultants conduct an interview to determine a client's need and the parameters of the search, evaluate available sources, and report their analysis to the client. I had always known colleagues who used their appraisal or arrangement and description expertise to become consulting archivists. But, to me, experts were the people who entered my reading room, already steeped in the knowledge of their subject area and wondering what gems I might be hiding in my collections.

最初，我与一位培训专家一起开发档案参考咨询工作坊。她立即告诉我，按照她逐渐形成的理解，档案参考咨询的工作就是顾问的工作。这对我而言是个新认识。但经过思考，我意识到，顾问会进行访谈，以确定客户的需求和查找范围，评估可用来源，并向客户报告分析结果。我一直知道有同事利用鉴定、整理与描述方面的专长，成为档案咨询顾问。但在我看来，专家是那些走进阅览室的人：他们早已深谙自己的研究领域，只是想知道我的馆藏中可能藏着什么珍宝。

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Whether I'm working with the world-famous scholar, the in-house administrator, or the undergraduate, I remind myself that, in this consulting interaction, their expertise is either in their subject or in their understanding of the product they are seeking to create (book, report, term paper). I am the resident expert in the knowledge of my collections, in my ability to educate them about how to gain access to them through catalogs, finding aids, subject guides, and so on, and in my familiarity with primary sources and the best ways to find and contextualize them.

无论面对世界知名学者、机构内部行政人员，还是本科生，我都提醒自己：在这种咨询互动中，他们的专长在于研究主题，或在于理解自己想要产出的成果——书籍、报告或学期论文。我的专长则在于了解本馆馆藏，能够教会他们通过目录、检索工具和主题指南等途径获取材料，以及熟悉一手资料，并知道怎样最好地找到它们、把它们放进背景中。

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The urge to replace this consultancy with so-called expert systems is strong. But, to get the most out of our collections, I maintain that interaction with the reference staff, not just the completion of an online questionnaire, will always be a necessary component of a successful research encounter in an archives. Researchers benefit from our knowledge of the entirety of our holdings, the strengths and weaknesses of certain collections, what's new, and information about related collections else-where—in other words, our expertise. Even with all the tools available, connecting particular researchers with particular sources is still a common practice. I often feel like a matchmaker when I encourage a researcher to look at a certain collection or type of collection (“No really—you'll love it!”).

人们很想用所谓专家系统取代这种咨询。然而，我坚持认为，要充分利用馆藏，与参考咨询人员的互动，而不仅仅是填一份网络问卷，始终是成功开展档案研究的必要组成部分。研究者受益于我们对全部馆藏的了解：特定馆藏的优点与不足、新增内容，以及其他机构相关馆藏的信息；换句话说，他们受益于我们的专长。即使有了所有这些工具，将特定研究者与特定来源连接起来，仍是一项常见工作。当我鼓励研究者查看某个馆藏或某类馆藏时，常常感觉自己像个媒人：“真的，你一定会喜欢！”

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Recently a visiting scholar spent a week in our reading room, examining the transcripts of an early twentieth- century murder trial. The issue behind the murder was housing integration, and the question at hand was the character of the neighborhood in transition. The scholar was well versed in the uses of all the technology at our disposal and made maximum use of all the guides and catalogs I showed to him. However, in conversation, I realized that he was unfamiliar with fire insurance maps, which show the layout of residential areas such as his neighborhood. Nothing in the catalog or finding aids would have led him to this source as it wouldn't be indexed by any subject headings meaningful to him. It was our mutual research partnership—or my mediation, if you prefer—that encouraged him to search this source. My broader knowledge of the range and nature of the sources at our disposal, and his knowledge of how to apply them to his own hypotheses, has led him to challenge widely held beliefs about the ethnicity and geography of the neighborhood in which the murder occurred.

最近，一位访问学者在阅览室待了一周，研究一桩二十世纪初谋杀案的审判记录。谋杀案背后的问题是居住空间的种族融合，而他关注的是一个正在转型的街区的性质。这位学者熟悉我们提供的各种技术，并充分使用了我向他介绍的全部指南和目录。然而，交谈中我发现，他并不熟悉火灾保险地图；这种地图能够展示他所研究的那类住宅区的布局。目录或检索工具都不会把他引向这一来源，因为它没有用对他而言有意义的主题词编入索引。正是我们双方的研究伙伴关系——或者，如果你愿意，可以称为我的中介作用——促使他查找这种资料。我对现有来源范围与性质的较广了解，加上他把这些来源应用于自身假设的知识，使他得以挑战人们对于案发街区族群构成与地理格局的普遍认识。

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Connecting mediation with consulting brings us to the concept of research strategy. This is the product that results from the consultancy. We can't hope to connect researchers with every document, let alone every collection that would be of use to them. But we can teach them how to use our tools, and, after listening carefully to their questions and needs, we can advise them about how best to approach our repository. We convey collection strengths, useful guides, ways to plan their time in view of offsite storage, size, and complexity of collections, and what to do about access restrictions. In addition, we understand local or institutional history or have general subject knowledge with which we can make connections they couldn't make as quickly, or perhaps at all.

把中介与咨询联系起来，便引出了研究策略的概念。这是咨询所产生的成果。我们不能指望把研究者与每一份有用文献，甚至每一个有用馆藏都联系起来。但我们能够教他们使用工具，认真倾听其问题与需求之后，建议他们怎样最好地利用本馆。我们会介绍馆藏优势、实用指南，说明怎样根据馆外存储、馆藏规模与复杂程度安排时间，以及如何处理开放利用限制。此外，我们了解地方或机构历史，或具备一般性的主题知识，能够建立研究者无法迅速建立、甚至根本无法建立的联系。

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Two final roles of the reference archivist are student and advocate. The student role is obvious: we learn every day from our researchers about the depth and breadth of our collections, but also about their potential uses and the types of documentation that current research demands. Especially this latter information informs a different type of mediation or “inreach” between the researcher and the rest of the archival staff: what are use trends, how are tools working, what are researchers looking for, what should we be collecting?

参考咨询档案员最后两种角色，是学生与倡导者。学生的角色显而易见：我们每天从研究者那里了解馆藏的深度与广度，也了解其潜在用途，以及当前研究所需要的文献类型。尤其是后一类信息，为研究者与其他档案工作人员之间的另一种中介，或“向内沟通”，提供依据：利用趋势是什么？工具的效果如何？研究者在找什么？我们应该收集什么？

Unmediated Use, or Caught in the Web

没有中介的利用，或陷入网络

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I have alluded several times to mediation in the online environment. The exponential growth of e-mail research requests makes this continually more obvious. Though they often are phrased less elegantly or completely, the nature of e-mail communication allows us truly to converse about points of access, collection recommendations, or referrals in ways traditional correspondence made cumbersome. The sort of research partnership referred to earlier in this essay now often starts with an e-mail inquiry, a back and forth clarification of the request, a referral to guidelines posted on a Web page, and a better prepared researcher arriving at our door. Web sites, too, allow us to mount information that is easy to download and ponder on a researcher's own timetable. We can also include explanations, or translations, of our terminology and structure for those who choose to learn about it in this way. Think of it as self-paced Berlitz at home.

我已数次提到网络环境中的中介。电子邮件研究请求呈指数增长，使这一点越来越明显。虽然电子邮件中的措辞往往不够优雅或完整，但这种沟通方式确实让我们能够围绕检索入口、馆藏推荐或转介展开对话，而传统通信方式会使这些交流十分繁琐。前面所说的研究伙伴关系，如今常常始于电子邮件咨询，接着来回澄清请求，引导研究者查看网页上的指南，最后迎来一位准备更充分的研究者。网站还使我们能够提供易于下载的信息，供研究者按照自己的时间安排仔细思考。我们也可以加入对术语和结构的解释或翻译，供愿意通过这种方式学习的人使用。可以把它理解为在家自行掌握进度的贝立兹课程。

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A more difficult situation concerns the use of electronic records, which never actually enter the repository but are managed by the archives via the records' office of origin. These postcustodial archives certainly will encourage unmediated use. On the other hand, making these records available will require that we produce some sort of digital mediation, or front end, to connect users with the record groups not in the archives' domain. Yakel reminds us that reference archivists often act as a filter.[15] She writes, “The archival challenge on the web becomes one of establishing a container [mechanism] that preserves or represents the evidence of the record while making explicit the thought process often involved in mediating between documents and users: *translating the user's subject- based question into a provenance-based system”* [my emphasis].[16] Certainly researchers have bypassed the reference staff for years, dismissing us with a click, declining to enter the research partnership, and navigating on their own. This may be more appealing or widespread via the Internet. The research partnership we offer is a value added aspect of archival service, not a requirement.

更困难的情形涉及电子文件的利用：这些文件从未实际进入档案保存机构，而是由档案馆通过文件形成部门加以管理。这类后保管模式的档案，无疑会鼓励没有中介的利用。但另一方面，为了开放这些文件，我们又需要制作某种数字中介或前端，把使用者与不在档案馆管辖范围内的全宗连接起来。雅克尔提醒我们，参考咨询档案员常常充当过滤器。[15]她写道：“网络上的档案挑战，在于建立一种容器 [机制] ，在保存或呈现文件证据的同时，明确展示文献与使用者之间进行中介时往往涉及的思考过程：把使用者基于主题的问题，转化为基于来源的系统” [着重号为本文作者所加] 。[16]当然，多年来研究者一直会绕过参考咨询人员，点一下鼠标便把我们打发走，不愿加入研究伙伴关系，而是自行探索。互联网可能使这种做法更具吸引力，或更为普遍。我们提供的研究伙伴关系，是档案服务的增值部分，而非强制要求。

Conclusion

结论

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I agree with my colleagues that the concept of agency and involvement, with both the records and the researchers, is one that is rarely considered. Like all service professionals, our values tell us that good service is invisible, not obtrusive. This, however, fails to acknowledge the significant roles we play in connecting researchers and records, and especially in producing and explaining the tools we create to facilitate this process. My own observation of interactions in the reference room indicate that many of us are so frustrated with our lack of influence in the research process that we withdraw behind a wall of bureaucracy and alienation from our researchers. Thinking instead of the ways in which we already shape the archives experience—and then working to improve them—will not only enhance our researchers' work lives but remind us of our own contributions to the research partnership.

我同意同事们的看法：关于我们面对文件和研究者时的能动性与参与，通常很少有人认真思考。与所有服务行业的专业人员一样，我们的价值观告诉我们，良好的服务应当不露痕迹，而不应引人注目。但这种观念没有承认我们在连接研究者与文件方面的重要作用，尤其没有承认我们在制作和解释促进这一过程的工具方面的作用。我对参考咨询室互动的观察表明，许多人因为自己在研究过程中缺乏影响力而极为沮丧，于是退到官僚程序的壁垒后面，与研究者疏离。转而思考我们已经如何塑造档案利用经验，并努力改进这些方式，不仅会改善研究者的工作生活，也会提醒我们自身对于研究伙伴关系的贡献。

NOTES
注释

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1. These quotes are found in the seminar presentation of Ann L. Stoler, “Colonial Archives and the Arts of Governance: On the Content in the Form,” in *Refiguring the Archive*, Carolyn Hamilton, ed. (Dordrecht: Kluwer), 2003. Sadly, Stoler and others equate the contents of the archives, influenced as they always will be by the availability of documentation—and of simple societal realities such as the inability of many historical subjects to write or leave documentation behind—with the institution of the archives. She thus confuses the archives—the repository in which these records rest and are, one hopes, now made generally accessible—with the intent of the original records creators and keepers of the documents

1. 这些引文出自安·L.斯托勒的研讨会报告《殖民档案与治理艺术：论形式中的内容》，收入卡罗琳·汉密尔顿编《重构档案》（多德雷赫特：Kluwer，2003）。遗憾的是，斯托勒等人将档案内容与档案机构等同起来；而档案内容始终受到文献可获得性的影响，也受到某些简单社会现实的影响，例如许多历史主体无法书写或留下文献。由此，她把档案——存放这些文件、并希望如今已使其普遍开放的保存机构——与最初文件形成者和文献保管者的意图混淆了。

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2. “Mediation is the Message: An Archival Challenge for the 21st Century,” *Archival Issues* 24:2 (1999), 111. Also, Nancy Bartlett, “Past Imperfect (*l'imparfait*): Mediating Meaning in Archives of Art,” this volume.

2. 《中介即讯息：二十一世纪的档案挑战》，《Archival Issues》24卷2期（1999），第111页。另见本书南希·巴特利特的《不完美的过去（l’imparfait）：在艺术档案中调解意义》。

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3. Paul Conway, “Partners in Research: Improving Access to the Nation's Archive/User Studies at the National Archives and Records Administration.” Pittsburgh: Archives and Museum Informatics, 1994. It was in Conway's publication that I first encountered the very apt and useful concept of this partnership.

3. 保罗·康韦：《研究伙伴：改善国家档案的利用 / 美国国家档案与文件管理局的使用者研究》（匹兹堡：Archives and Museum Informatics，1994）。我最初是在康韦的出版物中，接触到这个十分贴切而有用的伙伴关系概念。

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4. Elizabeth Yakel, “Thinking Inside and Outside the Boxes: Archival Reference Services at the Close of the Twentieth Century,” *Archivaria*, no. 49 (Spring 2000), 140—60, see p. 151.

4. 伊丽莎白·雅克尔：《在盒子内外思考：二十世纪末的档案参考咨询服务》，《Archivaria》第49期（2000年春），第140—160页，参见第151页。

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5. Blouin, unpublished opening remarks for Sawyer Seminar, Ann Arbor, Michigan, 2000.

5. 布卢因：索耶研讨会未发表的开场讲话，密歇根州安娜堡，2000年。

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6. Conversation with Joel Wurl, 1999.

6. 与乔尔·沃尔的交谈，1999年。

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7. In a recent e-mail query, a researcher referred to herself as “net stupid.” This apology seemed as important to her as her factual request.

7. 在最近一封电子邮件咨询中，一位研究者称自己“对网络很笨”。对她而言，这种致歉似乎与实际请求同样重要。

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8. Helen Willa Samuels. I am not aware that this was a published paper, but it was the title of many articles she wrote for various newsletters encouraging potential users of the Institute Archives, Massachusetts Institute of Technology.

8. 海伦·威拉·塞缪尔斯。我不知道这是否是一篇已发表的论文，但这是她为各种通讯撰写的多篇文章所用的标题，旨在鼓励麻省理工学院学院档案馆的潜在使用者。

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9. Available online at: http://www.library.yale.edu/mssa/tutorial/tutorial.htm

9. 可在线获取：http://www.library.yale.edu/mssa/tutorial/tutorial.htm

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10. Yakel, “Thinking Inside and Outside the Boxes,” 153.

10. 雅克尔：《在盒子内外思考》，第153页。

原书第 42 页 · 对照段落 049

11. For this wonderful turn of phrase, I am indebted to many conversations on this topic with Mary Jo Pugh, former reference archivist at the Bentley Historical Library.

11. 这个精彩说法得益于我与本特利历史图书馆前参考咨询档案员玛丽·乔·皮尤就此话题进行的多次交谈。

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12. Blouin, unpublished remarks for Sawyer Seminar..

12. 布卢因：索耶研讨会未发表的讲话。

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13. Society of American Archivists, Code of Ethics, adopted 1992, also available at http://www.archivists.org/governance/handbook/app_ethics.asp

13. 美国档案工作者协会：《伦理准则》，1992年通过。亦见：http://www.archivists.org/governance/handbook/app_ethics.asp

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14. Yakel, “Thinking Inside and Outside the Boxes,” 153.

14. 雅克尔：《在盒子内外思考》，第153页。

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15. Ibid., 143.

15. 同上，第143页。

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16. Ibid., 150. The earliest articulation of this concept is, of course, Pugh's “The Illusion of Omniscience: Subject Access and the Reference Archivist,” *American Archivist* 45:1 (1982).

16. 同上，第150页。这个概念最早的明确表述，当然是皮尤的《全知的幻觉：主题检索与参考咨询档案员》，《American Archivist》45卷1期（1982）。